

International style

Among the radical 20th-century ideas that spread from Europe to the United States was the international style, named at a 1932 exhibition at New York's Museum of Modern Art. It was called *Modern Architecture: International Exhibition*, and the architecture on display reflected the strong influence of the Bauhaus. The curators – architect/critic Philip Johnson and historian/critic Henry-Russell Hitchcock – wrote the accompanying catalogue, *The International Style: Architecture since 1922*, including work by Gropius, Rietveld, Le Corbusier and Mies van der Rohe. Hitchcock and Johnson identified three main principles of the international style: the expression of volume rather than mass, the emphasis on balance rather than symmetry and the abandonment of applied ornament. It was simple, honest and functional, utilizing steel, glass, reinforced concrete and chrome, with open interior spaces, white stucco walls, rectilinear forms, flat roofs and horizontal ribbon windows. In other words, it distilled the essence of European modernism or functionalism.



Villa Savoy interior, Le Corbusier 1928–31